

Wyoming Technology Licensing Inc. v. Hyundai Motor America

A public complaint analysis identifies the dispute as concerning Hyundai SmartSense Highway Driving Assist and Highway Lane Change Assist, and reports allegations directed to U.S. Patent Nos. 9,505,343 and 10,046,696. The reported issues concern the relationship between sensor inputs, a driver-operated lever, automatic lane-change control, statistical analysis, and machine-learning capability. This is preliminary analysis rather than a claim chart or opinion.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-24	U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Texas	3:26-cv-02840	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-27. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION Wyoming Technology Licensing Inc. v. Hyundai Motor America

FORUM / DOCKET U.S. District Court for the Northern District of Texas / 3:26-cv-02840

FILED / TYPE 2026-08-24 / patent infringement

PUBLIC DOCKET [Open docket](#)

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

The public docket identifies Wyoming Technology Licensing Inc. as plaintiff, Hyundai Motor America as defendant, Civil Action No. 3:26-cv-02840, an August 24, 2026 filing date, the Northern District of Texas, a jury demand, and a 35 U.S.C. § 271 patent-infringement cause of action. The docket describes the complaint as accompanied by attachments labeled patent-in-suit and claim-chart exhibits and identifies Joseph J. Zito as filer. The related FCA US LLC action is No. 3:26-cv-02839, also filed August 24, 2026. These are docket facts, not findings of infringement or validity.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Joseph J. Zito - Outside counsel, DNL Zito. Verified docket fact and analytical inference: the public docket identifies Zito as the filer of the complaint, notice of patent action, and disclosure statement for Wyoming Technology Licensing Inc. DNL Zito publicly identifies its practice as patent and intellectual-property litigation. That makes Zito a plausible initial recipient for preliminary expert-search research; it does not establish purchasing authority.

jzito@dnlzito.com - publicly printed in the [linked professional source](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

A public complaint analysis identifies the dispute as concerning Hyundai SmartSense Highway Driving Assist and Highway Lane Change Assist, and reports allegations directed to U.S. Patent Nos. 9,505,343 and 10,046,696. The reported issues concern the relationship between sensor inputs, a driver-operated lever, automatic lane-change control, statistical analysis, and machine-learning capability. This is preliminary analysis rather than a claim chart or opinion.

Secondary-source limitation: The docket describes multiple patent-in-suit and claim-chart attachments, while the public secondary analysis identifies two patents. The filed complaint, its exhibits, the complete intrinsic record, and discovery must control the asserted-patent list, claim construction, product mapping, and any technical conclusion. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. Patent No. 9,505,343](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 10,046,696](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Automatic-control state and lever operation

When Highway Driving Assist and Highway Lane Change Assist are used, what system changes state when a driver operates the turn-signal lever: the alleged automatic control itself, a feature within an already-active assistance system, or neither?

Potential evidence: Claim language and specification, vehicle owner manuals, HMI requirements, ECU state-machine design, CAN traces, event logs, source code, and controlled vehicle tests.

02 Sensor-to-control path

Which cameras, radars, maps, controllers, and software components receive environmental data and determine whether to issue a steering or lane-change command?

Potential evidence: System architecture, sensor specifications, ADAS ECU software, signal definitions, interface-control documents, diagnostic traces, calibration records, and vehicle testing.

03 Statistical analysis versus rules-based control

Does the accused system perform the claimed statistical analysis on sensor data to determine a vehicle-control parameter, or does it use deterministic thresholds, rule logic, or a materially different decision method?

Potential evidence: Algorithms, model specifications, source code, calibration tables, design reviews, simulation inputs and outputs, test data, and engineering testimony.

04 Machine-learning capability and historical-data use

Does any relevant Hyundai function use machine learning or historical data in the claimed sense, and if so, is it used to determine the asserted control parameter rather than for a separate design, training, or data-collection function?

Potential evidence: Training and deployment pipelines, model artifacts, embedded binaries, parameter-update logic, data-retention records, model cards, source code, and version histories.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Functional attribution across SmartSense features

Which specific SmartSense feature, vehicle model year, hardware configuration, and software release performs each alleged sensing, decision, signaling, or steering step?

Potential evidence: Feature matrices, VIN/build records, release notes, supplier specifications, dealer service materials, manuals, test vehicles, and version-control evidence.

06 Driver role, safeguards, and operating conditions

What driver confirmation, supervision, roadway conditions, and safety gates are required before a lane-change maneuver occurs, and do those requirements affect the proposed mapping of automatic operation on behalf of the driver?

Potential evidence: Human-machine-interface specifications, manuals, warning logic, operational-design-domain documents, safety analyses, test protocols, and recorded vehicle traces.

07 Technical alternatives and contribution

At the relevant time, what alternative architectures existed for lane-change assistance, sensor fusion, turn-signal interaction, and control-parameter selection, and what technical contribution—if any—is attributable to the asserted claim features?

Potential evidence: Contemporaneous papers, standards, patents, supplier documentation, product-development records, benchmark studies, and supported POSITA analysis.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Philip Koopman, PhD

Associate Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering, Carnegie Mellon University; affiliated with the Robotics Institute and Software and Societal Systems Department

TECHNICAL FIT

Automotive functional safety, autonomous-vehicle testing, embedded-system safety, and run-time monitoring directly fit the ADAS state, sensor, control, and safety-gate questions.

RELEVANT WORK

CMU describes more than 20 years of autonomous-vehicle-safety experience, work on stress testing and run-time monitoring for vehicle applications, and leadership of research on safe and secure embedded systems. His public resume identifies authorship of the UL 4600 Guidebook and autonomous-vehicle safety work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

His publicly posted resume states that he has served as an expert witness in patent, automotive-liability, and economic-loss class-action matters.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

CMU identifies a broad safety-and-validation focus; a separate product-specific review is needed to confirm fit to the asserted claim terms, Hyundai hardware generation, funding, and conflicts.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | koopman@cmu.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Mohan M. Trivedi, PhD

Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering, University of California San Diego

TECHNICAL FIT

Computer vision, multimodal sensing, driver-intent prediction, and autonomous-driving systems are directly relevant to vehicle sensing, lane-change evaluation, and driver/system interaction.

RELEVANT WORK

UC San Diego lists his extensive publication record; the CVRR autonomous-driving course identifies his work on predicting driver intent using multimodal sensory cues and frames autonomous driving around environment perception, motion prediction, and driver-state monitoring.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited sources establish perception and intelligent-vehicle expertise, but not Hyundai-specific software or a particular history of patent testimony; prior opinions and relationships require diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#) | [Source 3](#)

[Draft email](#) | mtrivedi@ucsd.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Ragunathan (Raj) Rajkumar, PhD

George Westinghouse Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering, Carnegie Mellon University; co-director of the General Motors-Carnegie Mellon Connected and Autonomous Driving Collaborative Research Lab

TECHNICAL FIT

Connected and autonomous driving, automotive embedded real-time systems, sensor networks, control architecture, and driver/vehicle mode transitions fit the claimed automatic-control and sensor-to-control questions.

RELEVANT WORK

CMU identifies him as director of Mobility21 and the Real-Time and Multimedia Systems Lab and co-director of the GM-CMU connected-and-autonomous-driving lab. His public research materials include ADAS driver-interaction work and connected-vehicle safety research.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The GM-CMU collaboration and industry-facing transportation work require particular relationship and conflict diligence; the sources do not establish a Hyundai-specific analysis.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#) | [Source 3](#)

[Draft email](#) | raj@ece.cmu.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Steven E. Shladover, PhD

Faculty/Lead Researcher, UC Berkeley Institute of Transportation Studies and PATH

TECHNICAL FIT

Vehicle-highway automation, cooperative adaptive cruise control, automated-driving systems, and vehicle-roadway warning and control are a close fit for automatic control, driving-assistance operating modes, and control-system evidence.

RELEVANT WORK

Berkeley lists his research interests as intelligent transportation systems, vehicle-highway automation, and autonomous vehicles, and describes his emphasis on cooperative systems and vehicle automation. His public biography identifies long-running work on vehicle-roadway warning and control standards.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His public record is strongest on transportation automation and standards, not necessarily embedded machine-learning implementation; current availability, role, and relationships must be checked before any contact.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#) | [Source 3](#)

[Draft email](#) | steve@path.berkeley.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Henry X. Liu, PhD

Bruce D. Greenshields Collegiate Professor, University of Michigan; Director of the University of Michigan Transportation Research Institute and Mcity

TECHNICAL FIT

Testing and evaluation of connected and automated vehicles, traffic-flow monitoring, modeling, control, and transportation AI fit vehicle control, test methodology, and intelligent-transportation-system context.

RELEVANT WORK

The University of Michigan Mobility Transformation Lab identifies Liu as director of UMTRI, Mcity, and the Center for Connected and Automated Transportation and describes research in testing and evaluation of connected and automated vehicles. A Michigan final report identifies work on cybersecurity in connected and automated vehicle systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His public profile is strongest on connected and automated-vehicle systems and evaluation rather than specific turn-signal or lane-change product code; inquiry would require scope-specific diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | henryliu@umich.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Matthew J. Barth, PhD

Distinguished Professor and Associate Dean of Research and Graduate Education, University of California Riverside; Esther and Daniel Hays Endowed Chair

TECHNICAL FIT

Connected and automated vehicles, cooperative perception, advanced navigation, real-world testing, and intelligent transportation systems fit the sensors, control, configuration, and test-evidence questions.

RELEVANT WORK

UCR describes research in connected and automated vehicles, cooperative perception systems, and advanced navigation, and identifies him as an IEEE Fellow. UCR's testing program describes hardware-in-the-loop CAV evaluation using a real vehicle and traffic simulation.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His documented work emphasizes ITS, mobility, and testbeds; detailed ADAS feature and patent-testimony fit would require separate diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | matthew.barth@ucr.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 John J. Leonard, PhD

Samuel C. Collins Professor of Mechanical and Ocean Engineering, Massachusetts Institute of Technology; member of MIT CSAIL and Technical Advisor to Toyota Research Institute

TECHNICAL FIT

Autonomous-vehicle navigation, mapping, robotics, AI, and vehicle safety work fit environmental perception, localization, lane-change decision inputs, and system-level integration.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT identifies research in navigation and mapping for autonomous mobile robots and describes his Toyota Research Institute technical-advisor work to improve vehicle safety with autonomous-driving technologies. He was an author of the DARPA Urban Challenge vehicle paper on a perception-driven autonomous urban vehicle.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Toyota Research Institute advisory work presents an obvious relationship-screening issue; his central work is navigation and mapping rather than the precise machine-learning claim limitation.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | jleonard@mit.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Jonathan P. How, PhD

Richard Cockburn Maclaurin Professor of Aeronautics and Astronautics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology; principal investigator, Aerospace Controls Laboratory

TECHNICAL FIT

Robust, adaptive, and model-predictive control; machine learning; motion planning; and autonomous-vehicle navigation fit questions concerning automatic-control logic and decision-making under uncertainty.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT identifies his research interests as robust control, adaptive control, model predictive control, machine learning, and reinforcement learning. MIT News describes his work on distributed robust planning for autonomous vehicles in dynamic environments.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His work spans aircraft, spacecraft, and ground autonomy; a vehicle-ADAS-specific and patent-testimony review would be needed before treating him as a final candidate.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#) | [Source 3](#)

[Draft email](#) | jhow@mit.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Daniela Rus, PhD

Director of MIT CSAIL; Panasonic Professor of Electrical Engineering and Computer Science at MIT

TECHNICAL FIT

Robotics, AI, autonomy, uncertainty quantification, and research on reliable machine-learning autonomous driving are relevant to machine-learning capability, automated decision logic, and robust control evidence.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT identifies Rus as CSAIL director and professor in AI/ML and robotics. MIT News reports Toyota-funded work on reliability of a machine-learning autonomous-driving solution and describes her work on AI uncertainty and reliability. MIT's autonomous-ground-vehicle workshop lists her as an organizer.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Her broad AI and robotics portfolio and Toyota-related work require particular conflict and availability diligence; the cited sources do not establish Hyundai-specific expertise.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#) | [Source 3](#)

[Draft email](#) | rus@csail.mit.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Alexander Amini, PhD

Research Affiliate, MIT CSAIL; autonomy and safe-decision-making researcher

TECHNICAL FIT

Robust learning, confidence estimation, end-to-end control, inertial refinement, and autonomous-vehicle control are a direct technical fit for the pleaded machine-learning and sensor-to-control issues.

RELEVANT WORK

MIT CSAIL identifies Amini's work on end-to-end autonomous-system control, confidence of neural networks, and inertial refinement, and lists publications including Robust Learning for Autonomous Vehicles and a variational-autoencoder approach to autonomous-driving control with novelty detection.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public sources; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited current role is research affiliate rather than a faculty or industry-lead position; any retained-expert role would require particularly careful review of testimonial experience, methodology, and conflicts.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | Amini@mit.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/texas/txndce/3%3A2026cv02840/425398>

Public professional email source: <https://dnlzito.com/>

Public technical context source: [https://ai-lab.exparte.com/case/dct/txnd/3%3A26-cv-02840/doc/analysis/1](https://ai-lab.experte.com/case/dct/txnd/3%3A26-cv-02840/doc/analysis/1)

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